r/Fencing • 2d ago
u/AJUKking

Are tennis shoes just the default recommendation for fencing?

Shoes

I kept get people telling me that tennis shoes are the same quality and have the same flat underside requirement needed for fencing, for half the price.

Is this accurate in everyone's assessments? Is there any reason to ever buy fencing shoes over tennis shoes?

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Paladin2019 • 2d ago
Épée

It's more squash or generic indoor court shoes that get recommended over tennis shoes, although indoor tennis shoes can work well too.

They are designed for the same surfaces and very similar body movements are are indeed about half the price of similar quality fencing shoes.

Of course fencing shoes have unique features designed especially for the sport but for my money they're not worth paying double for.

45 Reply

Xenadon • 2d ago

100% agree. Entry level fencing shoes are going to be $80-$100 and will wear out in a year or two. For that price you can get really nice indoor court shoes.

If you have a few hundred to spend though might as well get nice fencing shoes but most people don't really need them

14 Reply

antihippy • 1d ago

Hard agree. Take my kudos young Paladin.

2 Reply

grendelone • 2d ago
Foil

r/Fencing

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8 You Probably Didn't Need to Make Another Shoe Thread

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/r/Fencing FAQ

people used to also recommend indoor soccer shoes like the Adidas Sambas, but those aren't as appropriate as indoor court shoes.

11 Reply ···

BanditKitten • 1d ago

Épée

I will die with my Asics. It's the only brand of sneakers that fits my feet correctly.

3 Reply ···

AwkwardSploosh • 2d ago

Tennis shoes sometimes have more padding than fencing shoes. At the end of the day they are just shoes though. If you can be explosive and maintain balance you're pretty fine.

Some people (like me) prefer more of a minimalist/barefoot shoe like a wrestling shoe, Nike Ballestra, or Xero shoe. I do Sabre on grass most often so I use a Xero trail runner and it works wonderfully. Other people seem to prefer a more conventional tennis/running/basketball shoe, which helps a lot on harder surfaces and longer training sessions. There's no right answer, just preferences.

5 Reply ···

hokers • 2d ago

SABRE ON GRASS!!!?!

7 Reply ···

AwkwardSploosh • 2d ago

Yup! Wet grass last week haha. Managing spacing is a bit different since you can't be as explosive, but our training carries over regardless of who's yard or what park we are in. It also lets us party and grill out while we fence in a back yard, instead of having to go to a gym, which leads to us sparring twice a week easily.

3 Reply ···

t_ommi • 2d ago

Épée

Yes, I've used Adidas indoor tennis shoes for years. Bought 3 of the same pair last time because they often go out of stock and get phased out.

8 Reply ···

Aranastaer • 2d ago

If you are fencing in aluminium pistes regularly then yes for Epee at least tennis shoes are the way (squash shoes if you normally fence on typical indoor floor).
For example I used the asics gel rocket from 2007 until five years ago with one season of using the Nike ballestras when they came out (big

Glossary of Terms

SOME HELPFUL LINKS

Int, Fencing Federation

IWAS Wheelchair Fencing

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Fencing Discord Channel

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NCAA Fencing Homepage

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seven days a week, 7 hours each day and I was coaching a lot of Sabre as well as Epee.
If you are going to be doing a lot of classical footwork then a specific fencing shoe has merit for the changes of direction, the low profile to the ground etc. That said if I were to go back to fencing competitively I would go back to a tennis or squash shoe. I bounce when I fence and otherwise mostly I'm making big lunges or flèches which result in big impacts in my front heel. The extra cushioning in tennis shoes is to my benefit then.
Personally it's between three shoes for me. The adidas barricade.
Mizuno have a shoe that is very popular among fencers or going back to asics.
I'm tempted by the newest kempa shoe but honestly I'll probably end up with something tennis style next since I'm not really doing much high intensity footwork at the moment.

1 Reply ···

Xenadon • 2d ago

I just replaced my mid 2000s gel rockets as well with a new pair. Those shoes are so durable

1 Reply ···

n8udd • 1d ago

I wear indoor football shoes and they work great!

2 Reply ···

OrcOfDoom • 15h ago

Épée Top 1% Commenter

I just bought a pair of indoor soccer/football shoes. So far, I really like them. They are really light. They were a little tight to start but they quickly broke in and they feel really comfortable now. It's been about two weeks.

1 Reply ···

LarsSeprest • 2d ago • Edited 2d ago

Certain models just may fit your feet better. The nike air zoom fencing shoes were GOAT'd for me until ebay stock stopped being reliable. They were closer to the ground compared to other shoes. Would have been painful if used for sprinting across a tennis court . Tennis shoes will have better drag protection than most other shoes, but squash/volleyball/badminton shoes all have good stability.

Mirroring the comments above, my favorite Asics shoes got a model redesign which made them probably better for tennis but still bulkier and less flexible for fencing where you are on the balls of your feet constantly. I now have six pairs of the same shoe just in case they change it for the worse again.

6 Reply ···

Gooseberriesspike • 2d ago

u/TheFencingCoach
Former USA Fencing President/Chair

u/comment-nuke

u/evasion-guard

u/sub-stats-bot

u/admin-tattler

View all moderators

INSTALLED APPS

Comment Mop

Admin Tattler

Subreddit Statistics

Evasion Guard

Reddit Rules Privacy Policy User Agreement
Your Privacy Choices Accessibility
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shoes that work quite well.

2 Reply ···

ZebraFencer • 2d ago
Epee Referee Top 1% Commenter

> One benefit of the pickleball boom is there are a lot of pickleball shoes that work quite well.

[think there was a typo in the original comment]

The Asics one is called the Gel Renma. Works well for fencing and is more durable over the toe than the Gel Rockets.

1 Reply ···

Oakfrost • 2d ago

Still love my asics gel rocket volleyball shoes. Just bought a new pair

1 Reply ···

AmyrlinFoil • 1d ago

Just bought my first pair last month. So far they seem to be working just fine.

1 Reply ···

Rimagrim • 2d ago
Sabre

Not tennis. Volleyball, badminton, squash, generic indoor court. Also, price does matter. If you compare a $150 pair of volleyball shoes with a $50 pair, you will see major differences in construction and materials. I would say, apples-to-apples in terms of quality, you might get a 25 to 30% discount by going with shoes made for a more popular sport. If you are getting a 75% discount, it's likely not apples-to-apples.

2 Reply ···

play-what-you-love • 2d ago

Outdoor tennis shoes (with very thick soles) are not gonna work. You want relatively thin-soled - so you can feel the piste - with rounded heels (for better lunge action). Asics gel-rockets are quite a favorite for many in this regard as very good alternatives to full-fledged fencing shoes.

2 Reply ···

jdude_97 • 2d ago

I used tennis shoes for a time but found them too high in the ankle and too heavy. The best non fencing specific shoe I ever used was a volleyball shoe. But I liked fencing specific shoes the best

2 Reply ···

NameAlreadyClaimed • 21h ago

country) will get certain technology before other shoes will just because it's something of a pilot program, but all court shoes are far more like each other than footwear companies want you to think they are.

Buy at the low end and you will generally get a solid proven shoe with tech from a few years ago. Buy a generation behind the latest and you'll usually get something indistinguishable from the latest thing. Buy the middle-high model a generation behind the latest on special and you'll get by far the best bang for your buck.

Disclaimer; it was well over 15 years ago that I was in the industry. It could have changed. I doubt it though.

1 Reply ···

MisbegottenSon_063 • 1d ago

I assumed that fencing shoes are the default, and tennis/court shoes are secondary - often due to budget and how often one goes through shoes. My daughter uses Azza fencing shoes bc she needs lots of support and Azza's really are the best for support. As for Asics, the Gel Rocket is a great shoe but the Gel Dedicate is a sturdier, more structured shoe. I wish she would try the Gel Dedicate but she likes what she likes.

1 Reply ···

PapstJL4U • 1d ago

Foil

Most people don't fence on a level, where the show weight makes difference, neither in speed nor in stamina.

There are 20+ things to do to get better at fencing and a fencing shoe for double the price and half the durability, is low on the list. Beginners (and - imho- hobbyists) should definitely go with durable Tennis shoes over fencing shoes.

1 Reply ···

TeaKew • 1d ago

One of the best things about buying court shoes instead of fencing shoes is that the range of available shoes is much wider - which means you have a much better chance of finding a pair that fit your feet well.

1 Reply ···

jilrani • 2d ago

Épée

My kid and I use shoes that are marketed for volleyball and other indoor court sports. Way cheaper than fencing shoes, they seem to last just as long as those in the club that buy actual fencing shoes, and they fit our feet well.

1 Reply ···

jdude_97 • 2d ago

volleyball shoe. But I liked fencing specific shoes the best

1 Reply ···

sofyabar • 2d ago

Are they comfortable for your feet while fencing? Then why not? It really depends on individual feet.

1 Reply ···

Salt-3 • 2d ago

I really enjoy court shoes. Specifically volley ball shoes. Theyre made for lateral movements so they really support lunges

1 Reply ···

weedywet • 2d ago • Edited 2d ago

Foil Top 1% Commenter

No

I find tennis shoes way too heavy and bulky.

Some people like “court” shoes. Usually badminton.

Personally I find actual fencing shoes much better.

0 Reply ···

Midoritora • 2d ago

It depends on your weapon.

1 Reply ···